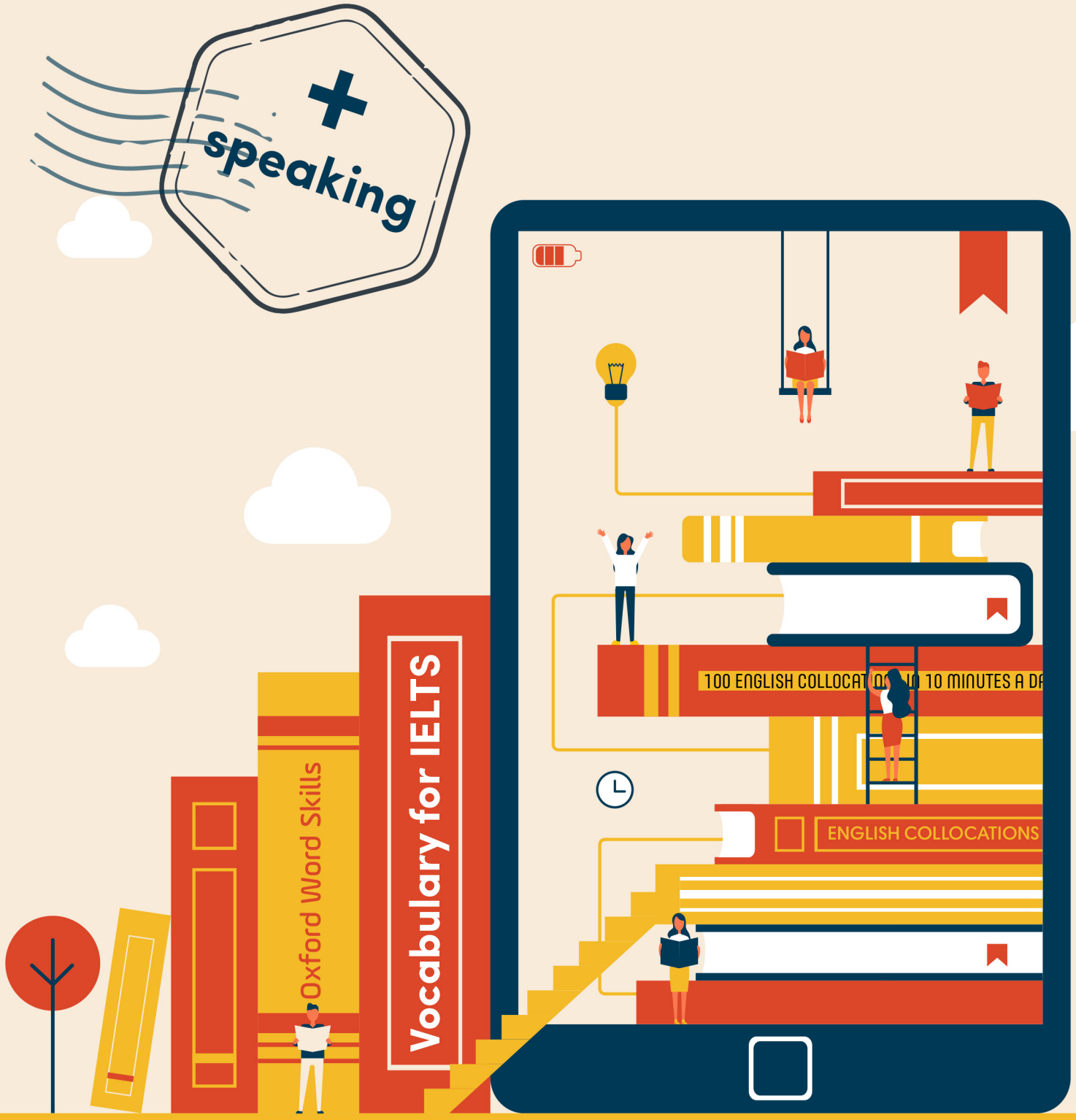
IELTS Up Words!

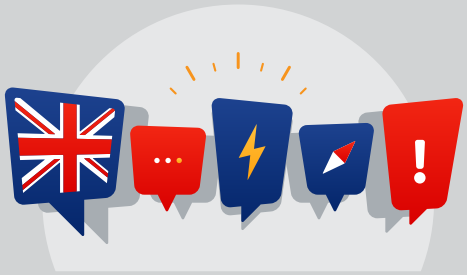
دوره لغات آیلتس

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Lesson 56: Government

Hello there. You are listening to lesson fifty-six of IELTS Up Words. I am Yasi, your IELTS mentor from Lingemy.com. In this lesson, we are going to talk about a topic that might come up in the third part of the speaking test—the government.

As you know ,the government has an obligation to keep society prosperous. It does so by giving responsibilities to the people who work for it, such as mayors, civil servants, bureaucrats, members of parliament, and the president.

Now I want to read a passage from the book "Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced," lesson eight, as this text is full of new words and useful expressions that might come in handy. After reading it, I will go through it once again to analyze the words used in it.

A welfare state is a taxation system that allows the state to provide for the economic and social well-being of its citizens. It is based on the notion of equal opportunities for all, equitable distribution of wealth, and public responsibility for those unable to meet their own needs. The general term may cover a variety of forms of assistance but principally involves the payment of some form of pension. There are two main interpretations of the idea of a welfare state. One is a model in which the state assumes primary responsibility for the welfare of its citizens and in which all aspects of welfare are considered to be the right of every citizen. Alternatively, a welfare state can refer to the creation of a safety net to provide social services, such as free childcare.

The existence of pensions can be traced back as far as the Roman Empire when soldiers were provided with a pension on retiring from military service. The modern welfare system in the UK developed during the late nineteenth and twentieth centuries and includes the provision of both cash welfare benefits (such as an old-age pension or unemployment benefit) and welfare services not involving money (such as healthcare). Through these provisions, a welfare state can empower its citizens and directly affect their well-being and personal autonomy. Welfare systems began to develop intensively at the end of World War II when non-government organizations (e.g. charities) became important providers of social services.

Speaking Tip



Part Three: Certainty

In part three, you are usually asked to state your opinion on an abstract concept. For example, take a look at the below question.

Do you think the government should be responsible for maintaining parks?

When asked about your opinion, you can either state it with certainty or uncertainty. If you have a strong opinion about something, or if you want to answer with complete certainty, you can use the following phrases to do so:

1. Yes, I truly feel that the maintenance of parks is on the government.
2. Yes, I think it is clearly on the government to maintain parks.
3. Yes, I strongly believe that their maintenance is on the government.
4. Yes, I think it is definitely on the government to keep parks maintained.

Remember that after stating your opinion, you must support it by giving a reason or an example.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to have an obligation	if you have an obligation, you should or must do something	تعهدداشتن؛ وظیفه‌داشتن	have a duty/ responsibility
a prosperous society	a successful society, usually by earning a lot of money	یک جامعهٔ پررونق و موفق	an affluent society
mayor	a person who is elected or chosen to lead the group who governs a town or city	شهردار	compare with governor and premier
civil servant	someone who works in a department of a country's government but who is not a part of its military	کارمند دولت	public servant; state employee
bureaucrat	a person with an official position in the government	مأمور دولتی/اداری	government official
a member of parliament	someone elected by the people in a particular area to represent them in a country's parliament	نمایندهٔ مجلس	abbreviation: MP
the president	the person who has the highest political position in a country that is a republic and who, in some of these countries, is the leader of the government	رئیس‌جمهور	compare with prime minister

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
welfare	the help given to people who need it, especially because they do not have enough money	مستمری؛ کمک رفاهی دولت	social assistance; government provision
taxation system	a legal system for assessing and collecting taxes	دستگاه مالیاتی	tax collection
the state	a country or its government	کشور؛ دولت	nation
equitable distribution of wealth	distributing wealth fairly and impartially	توزیع منصفانهٔ دارایی / ثروت	opposite: inequitable; unfair
the state assumes primary responsibility for the welfare of its citizens	the government takes control of its citizens' welfare	دولت مسئولیت اصلی [تأمین] کمک رفاهی به شهروندان خود را به‌عهده می‌گیرد	take responsibility
a safety net to provide social services	a system or plan for helping people, companies, etc. that are having problems, especially financial problems	تضمینی برای ارائهٔ خدمات اجتماعی	
the provision of welfare benefits	the act of providing welfare benefits, such as housing assistance and health care	تأمین مزایای رفاهی	supplying; providing
old-age pension	a regular amount of money that people receive from the government when they have retired from work	حقوق بازنشستگی	social security benefit/payment (AmE)
unemployment benefit	payment made by the state to an unemployed person	حقوق بیکاری	unemployment compensation

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to empower its citizens	to give power or authority to its citizens	اختیار و قدرت‌دادن به شهروندان خود	empowerment
personal autonomy	self-directing freedom and especially moral independence	استقلال/خودمختاری شخصی	autonomous

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
come in handy	turn out to be useful	مفید واقع‌شدن؛ به‌کارآمدن	be of use; prove useful
notion	a belief or idea	ایده؛ عقیده	concept
a variety of forms of assistance	different forms of assitance	اشکال مختلف کمک/ مساعدت	different forms of aid/support
principally	mainly	به‌طورکلی؛ اساساً	mostly; chiefly; for the most part
to trace something back	to discover the causes or origins of something by examining how it has developed	ریشه یا منشأ چیزی را یافتن	
a strong opinion	A strong opinion is one that is firmly held, deeply believed.	عقیده‌ای قوی که شخص عمیقاً به آن اعتقاد دارد	



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